# Nara Chung

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Website | LinkedIn | CV last updated: October 2026

## Current Position

**Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, Colorado State University** *2021–Present*

## Job Market Paper

**"Labor Market Deregulation and Deaths of Despair: Evidence from Advanced Economies"**

Employment protection legislation (EPL) deregulation has expanded labor market flexibility across advanced economies, with underexplored consequences for population health. This paper asks whether such deregulation contributes to deaths of despair (drug overdoses, alcohol-related disease, and suicide), a mortality pattern first documented in the United States. Using OECD employment protection indicators and WHO mortality data for 26 economies from 1998–2019, I apply local projections to trace the dynamic mortality response to major EPL reforms. Drug use disorder and suicide mortality rise significantly within five years of deregulation, with no significant rise in alcohol-related mortality. Some of these responses are moderated by institutional context: health-system effectiveness attenuates drug and inflammatory heart disease mortality; income support protects against suicide and violence mortality but, unexpectedly, amplifies the alcohol-mortality response; and higher poverty dampens the drug-mortality response, consistent with an affordability channel. As suggestive evidence on mechanisms, net family income for low-wage families falls and the short-tenure employment share rises after major deregulation. These findings indicate that labor market deregulation carries public-health costs, which social safety nets and health-system capacity can mitigate.

## Education

**Ph.D. in Economics, Colorado State University** *Expected May 2027*

*Dissertation:* "Essays on Labor Market Institutions, Financial Structure, and Deaths of Despair"
*Committee:* Daniele Tavani (Chair), Ray Miller, Marwil J. Dávila-Fernández, Brad Conner

**M.A. in Economics, Colorado State University** *2023*

**M.A. in TESOL, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, South Korea** *2015*

**B.A. in Economics, Sogang University, South Korea** *2013*

## Research Area

**Fields:** Macroeconomics, Labor Economics, Health Economics
**Interests:** Deaths of Despair, Employment Protection Legislation, Growth Cycles, Financialization

## Additional Research

**"The Addicted Predator–Prey Model: How Opioid Use Disorder Shapes Productivity and Growth-Cycle Dynamics."** with Marwil J. Dávila-Fernández.

**"Local Financialization, Financial Distress, and Deaths of Despair."**

## Research Experience

**Research Assistant, Regional Economic Development Institute (REDI)** *Summer 2022*

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO

**Summer Intern, CSU Extension** *Summer 2024*

*Economic and Community Contribution Analysis of the Forest Product Industry in Colorado*

## Publications

Chung, Nara. 2018. "Adopting Conceptual Metaphors as a Persuasive Device in Learners' Argument." *The Korean Journal of Applied Linguistics* 34(4): 25–51. *[Pre-Ph.D., Applied Linguistics]*

## Conference Presentations

"The Addicted Predator–Prey Model: How Opioid Use Disorder Shapes Productivity and Growth-Cycle Dynamics." ASSA Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, January 2027. *Forthcoming.*

"The Addicted Predator–Prey Model: How Opioid Use Disorder Shapes Productivity and Growth-Cycle Dynamics." Keynes Year Conference, Online, 2026.

"Labor Market Deregulation and Deaths of Despair: Evidence from Advanced Economies." Western Economic Association International Annual Conference, Denver, CO, 2026.

"Labor Market Deregulation and Deaths of Despair: Evidence from Advanced Economies." Western Social Science Association Annual Conference, Albuquerque, NM, 2026.

"Labor Market Deregulation and Deaths of Despair: Evidence from Advanced Economies." John Jay College–New School Conference on Contemporary Political Economy, New York, NY, 2026.

"Labor Market Deregulation and Deaths of Despair: Evidence from Advanced Economies." CSU Grad-Show, Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO, 2025.

"Adopting Conceptual Metaphors as a Persuasive Device in Learners' Argument." 13th Asia TEFL International Conference, Nanjing University, Nanjing, China, 2015. *[Pre-Ph.D., Applied Linguistics]*

## Teaching Experience

**Graduate Teaching Instructor, Colorado State University** *Spring 2025–Present*

### ECON 204 Principles of Macroeconomics

Spring 2025 — 2 sections, 134 students
Fall 2025 — online, 22 students
Spring 2026 — 1 section, 165 students

### ECON 212 Racial Inequality and Discrimination

Summer 2025 — online, 12 students
Spring 2026 — online, 13 students

### ECON 315: Money and Banking

Fall 2025 — online, 15 students

**Graduate Teaching Assistant, Colorado State University** *Fall 2021–Spring 2024*

**ECON 202 Principles of Microeconomics**

Fall 2021 & Spring 2022
Spring 2024

**ECON 204 Principles of Macroeconomics**

Fall 2022
Spring & Fall 2023

**Assistant Professor, Republic of Korea Naval Academy** *2016–2019*

English Reading
English Composition
Military Practical English
Communication

## Scholarships and Awards

**Outstanding Graduate Teacher Award, CSU Economics Department** *2025–2026*

**Graduate Research Assistantship Award, CSU Economics Department** *2025–2026*

**College of Liberal Arts Top Scholar Award, CSU GradShow** *2025*

**L.S. and Chuen-mei Fan Graduate Scholarship, CSU Economics Department** *2022–2023*

## Service

**President and Vice President, Korean Student Association, Colorado State University** *2023–2024*

**Community Coordinator, University Village 1700, CSU Housing** *2023–2025*

## Languages and Technical Skills

**Languages:** Korean (native), English (fluent)
**Software:** Stata, R, Python, LaTeX

## References

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